

Kennedi White

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◆ EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz | PhD in Earth & Planetary Sciences **Expected Jun. 2030**

Howard University | B.S. in Physics | B.A. in English **Jun. 2021 - May 2025**

- GPA: 3.87/4.0
- Minor: Math
- Howard University Karsh STEM Scholar : Thirty-two selected scholars committed to earning a PhD or MD/PhD in STEM (2021-Present)

Savannah Technical College

Aug. 2017 - May 2020

- GPA: 4.0/4.0
- Non-degree dual enrollment student
- 33 total credits earned

◆ HONORS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- Future of STEM Scholars Initiative (FOSSI) : scholars selected and awarded to pursue degrees in STEM at Historically Black Colleges and Universities (HBCUs) (2021 - Present)
- Published work in *The Sterling Notes*, Howard University (2022, 2023)
- Published work in *Girls Who Aint Afraid To Curse When Communicating With God*, Jayla Lawton and Trelani Michelle (2020)
- Published work in *Deep Spring 2015: Stories From Savannah's Center-City Schools*, Deep Center (2015)

◆ EXPERIENCE

Post-Baccalaureate Research Intern

May 2025 - Aug. 2025

GEM Fellowship Program | Los Alamos National Laboratory

- Identified gamma ray bursts using ground based operations
- Detected gamma ray bursts and modeled their dispersion using trigger algorithms

Summer Student Research Intern

Jun. 2024 - Aug. 2024

MIT Summer Research Program | Massachusetts Institute of Technology

- Detected directly imaged exoplanets using convolutional neural networks
- Used machine learning to examine parts of an astral image taken by telescopes and coronagraphs to distinguish noise and exoplanets

Student Research Intern

May 2023 - Present

Maximizing Student Potential in STEM Program | NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory

- Observation and Analysis of Imaging and Spectroscopy of Outer Planet Atmospheres
- Reduced and analyzed the near infrared thermal images and spectra of Jupiter to understand 2018-2022 EZ disturbance

Research Assistant

Aug. 2022 - Present

Lunar Environment and Dynamics for Exploration Research | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Examining the effect of a solar storm on the Moon's OH (-hydroxyl) surface content and H₂ exosphere
- Modeling the lunar exosphere and simulating solar storms to better understand the lunar hydrogen cycle

Storyteller Apprenticeship Recipient

Aug. 2022 - Jun. 2023

Deep Storyteller Apprenticeship | Savannah, Georgia

- Sponsored podcast created with a peer entitled: Black College Chronicles with Ken and Bri

Inaugural Cohort Member

Jun. 2022 - Jul. 2022

NASA Student Airborne Science Activation Internship | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Summer internship covering topics such as basic remote sensing principles, basic atmospheric

thermodynamics, atmospheric stability, and data analysis

- Individual research project on using machine learning ensemble models to measure model accuracy on unseen data titled Summer air quality index prediction with machine learning model classifiers

A.R.T Member

Jan. 2019 - Jun. 2022

Deep Action Research Team | Savannah, Georgia

- Student representative on Savannah Racial Equity and Leadership (REAL) Task Force (2020-2021)
- Lead facilitator for the creation of the student Bill of Demands presented to city and county council (2020)
- Served as student representative with school board and superintendent to draft new student code of conduct (2020)
- City-wide spoken word performances on toxic masculinity, race, sexuality, etc. (2019 - Feb. 2020)
- Served as student representative with local juvenile judges to draft new student favored legislation (2019)

◆ PRESENTATIONS

MIT Summer Research Program

Aug. 2024

MIT Summer Research Program | Space Telecommunications Astronomy Radiation Lab

- Presented poster presentation entitled “[A.I. x Astro: Machine Learning Models for Exoplanet Detection](#)”

Howard University Research Symposium

Apr. 2024

Lunar Environment and Dynamics for Exploration Research | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Presented oral presentation entitled “[Variation of the Moon’s Solar-Induced Hydrogen Cycle during a Solar Storm](#)”

2023 American Geophysical Union National Conference

Dec. 2023

Lunar Environment and Dynamics for Exploration Research | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Presented poster presentation entitled “[The Moon’s Solar-Induced Hydrogen Cycle during a Solar Storms](#)”

NASA Exploration Science Forum

Jul. 2023

Lunar Environment and Dynamics for Exploration Research | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Presented oral presentation entitled “[Variation of the Moon’s Solar-Induced Hydrogen Cycle during a Solar Storms](#)”

Howard University Research Symposium

Apr. 2023

Lunar Environment and Dynamics for Exploration Research | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Presented oral presentation entitled “[Impact of Solar Storms on the Moon’s Hydrogen Cycle](#)”

22nd American Meteorological Society Student Conference

Jan. 2023

NASA Student Airborne Science Activation Internship | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

- Presented poster project entitled “[Summer Air Quality Index Prediction with Machine Learning Model Classifiers](#)”

♦ PUBLICATIONS

Investigating Jupiter’s Atmosphere Through Near-Infrared Thermal Imaging and Spectral Analysis In Prep
Maximizing Student Potential in STEM Program | NASA Jet Propulsion Laboratory

Changes in the Moon’s Solar-Induced Hydrogen Cycle During Coronal Mass Ejections In Prep
Lunar Environment and Dynamics for Exploration Research | National Aeronautic and Space Administration

♦ ACTIVITIES

President, Corresponding Secretary Apr. 2023 - May 2025
Zeta Phi Beta Sorority, Incorporated | Howard University

General Member Jan. 2022 - May 2025
Sterling Allen Brown English Society | Howard University

Executive Member, General Member Aug. 2022 - May 2025
Society of Physics Students | Howard University

General Member Oct. 2022 - May 2025
National Council of Negro Women | Howard University

Co-President, Executive Officer Apr. 2022 - May 2025
Tau Beta Pi - DC Alpha Chapter | Howard University

- PR team member aiding in social media and community outreach

General Member Aug. 2021 - May 2025
Society of Women Engineers | Howard University

- Occasionally aids the PR team with social media and community outreach

General Member Jun. 2021 - Aug. 2023
Kwame Ture Society | Howard University

Student Reviewer Jun. 2021 - May 2022
Ukweli Undergraduate Research Journal | Howard University

- Read and reviewed submitted manuscripts to help select those represented in the journal (2021)

♦ SKILLS

Languages: English, Haitian Creole

Technical Skills: Fusion 360, Python, MATLAB, Fortran, LaTeX, IDL, Pylang, PyTorch, Git, GEANT, C++

Certifications & Training: MATLAB